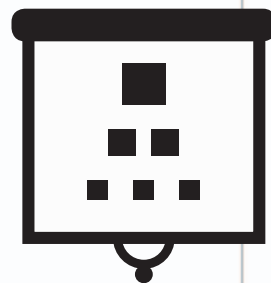




OPTOMETRIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

An optometrist is a specialized doctor who examines a patient's eyes to test their sight and check for injury, disease, or other conditions, such as diabetes and high blood pressure. They use specialty eye-testing equipment to diagnose eyesight problems, prescribe glasses or contact lenses to correct defects in vision, and prescribe medications to treat and manage eye diseases.



SALARY

Newly qualified optometrist ★★☆☆☆
Consultant optometrist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Strong competition for jobs • Growing sector with good career prospects • Job opportunities in optician practices, retail stores, hospitals, and doctor's clinics

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Eye care • Health care • Biology • Physics • Chemistry • Mathematics • Science • English • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in optometry and professional license are required before practicing as an optometrist.



LIFESTYLE Optometrists work regular office hours, but evening and weekend work may be required. Part-time consultancy work is also available.



LOCATION Optometrists spend most of their time working in a private consulting or treatment room in an optician's practice, a clinic, or a hospital.



THE REALITIES Most of the work is spent conducting eye examinations inside a small room with no natural light, in close proximity to patients.

CAREER PATHS

After qualifying, most optometrists find work in independent practices or with larger companies that provide eye care to the public. Some work in hospitals, supporting other doctors and surgeons to deal with more complex eye problems; others work for manufacturers of spectacles and contact lenses, developing new products.

OPTICIAN If you have worked as an optician or optometric technician, your experience will help you when applying to medical school.



GRADUATE You need a bachelor's degree and doctorate of optometry degree, and to pass a series of exams, before becoming an optometrist.

